Nima Etemad Golestani

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Education

M.Sc. in Computer Engineering Sep 2023 - Peresent
Islamic Azad University, Mashhad Branch
Department of Computer Engineering and Information Technology
• **Overall GPA:** 19.22/20
• **Thesis:** "Enhancing Sentiment Analysis on Game Reviews Using Few-shot Prompting on Large Language Model and Review Importance Score Estimation"

B.Sc. in Computer Engineering Sep 2018 - Feb 2023
Islamic Azad University, Mashhad Branch
Department of Computer Engineering and Information Technology
• **Overall GPA:** 16.58/20 • **Last two years' GPA:** 18/20

Research Interests

• **Video Game** • **Game AI** • **Generative AI** • **NLP** • **Game-based Learning** • **Reinforcement Learning**

Publications

• Etemad Golestani, N., Moattar, M.H. Lightweight hybrid adaptive weighted ensemble integrating fine-tuned SBERT with lexical and statistical models for robust steam review sentiment classification. Discover Computing 29, 367 (2026). https://doi.org/10.1007/s10791-026-10296-6 Open Access

• Etemad Golestani, N., Veisi, G., Kheir Khah, E. Enhancing sentiment analysis on game reviews using few-shot prompting on large language model and review importance score estimation (2026). (Under Review)

• Etemad Golestani, N., Bahrepour, D. Game-Based Learning for Human-Centered Smart Education: A Focused Integrative Review of Evidence and Design Conditions. KMEB 2026 (A-2083-3168) Open Access

Honors and Awards

Certificate of Rank Jun 2026
Islamic Azad University, Mashhad branch Certificate
• Honored to achieve the **Second Rank** among 52 fellow students in the Master of Computer Engineering - AI and Robotics

Ph.D. admission in Computer Science Fall 2024
University of Louisiana at Lafayette Certificate
• Honored to be granted a fully-funded direct Ph.D in Computer Science admission under Dr. Arun K. Kulshreshth's supervision
• Was unable to enroll due to the 2025 U.S. travel ban

Academic Experience

Conference Reviewer Sep 2026 - Sep 2026
ICCKE 2026 Mashhad, Iran
• Honored to serve as a Reviewer for the 16th International Conference on Computer and Knowledge Engineering.
• Contributing to peer review in machine learning, data analysis, classification, regression, and ensemble learning.

Teaching Assistant Oct 2023 - Feb 2024
Ferdows Institute of Higher Education Mashhad, Iran
Game Development Course
• Delivered tutorials on Unity development and game-programming concepts.
• Reviewed assignments and provided technical feedback to students.

Teaching Assistant Jan 2023 - May 2024
Game Dojo Mashhad, Iran
Game Development Course
• Assisted instructors with course delivery and assessment.
• Supported students with debugging, project design, and implementation.

Work Experience

AI Software Engineer Jun 2026 - Present
Armitaj Mashhad, Iran
• Use pre-trained and fine-tuned models and existing AI tools to improve user experiences and build new products.
• Develop AI-powered software solutions tailored to the operational needs of commercial and residential towers.

Game Developer, Unity Engine Specialist Aug 2021 - May 2024
White Designers Studios Mashhad, Iran
• Worked on several casual and hyper-casual game titles
• Gained experience and improved skills in programming, environmental design, and Unity engine development

Member of the Scientific Association of the Computer Engineering Department (Unpaid) Sep 2021 - Sep 2022
Islamic Azad University Mashhad, Iran
• Organized and hosted events and webinars
• Assisted students in course selection and academic planning

Projects

Dota 2 Patch Analyzer Jun 2026
AI Engineer GitHub Link
- Developed a RAG application enabling natural language querying of Dota 2 patch notes across multiple versions.
- Implemented vector search using FAISS with Sentence Transformers for semantic retrieval of heroes, items, and mechanics updates
- Integrated an LLM to generate context-aware answers with source attribution to specific patches and sections
- Added auto-crawling functionality to fetch patch data directly from Valve's official API

Steam Review Collector Dec 2025
Software Developer GitHub Link
- Developed a Python script to collect Steam game reviews via the Steam Web API and export them to CSV.
- Implemented filtering by games, review length, number of reviews per game, and date of review

Catch First! Dec 2022
Game Developer, Level Designer GitHub Link
- A 3D Up-Down Zero-player game
- Designed a 3D up-down zero-player game
- Implemented reinforcement learning using ML-Agent with a neural network trained up to 3.5 million steps with an accuracy of 0.993.

Flappy Fly Feb 2025
Game Developer, Level Designer GitHub Link
- Developed a Python-based clone of Flappy Bird enhanced with AI agents trained via the NEAT algorithm

Stone Age Jan 2025
Game Developer, Level Designer Google Drive
- Developed a 2D platformer in Unity aimed at teaching English to 1st-year high school students in Iran through game-based learning
- Implemented core, UI, level flow systems, and interactive learning elements to integrate curriculum content

Gnar Mar 2021 - Sep 2022
Game Developer, Level Designer Google Drive
- A dynamic mega-city Sport Open-World metaverse with captivating 16-bit graphics based on WebGL
- Exclusively designed for Nounz NFT holders
- Designed and Construct parts of the Map
- Worked on parts of the code such as Core, Mission, Profile, etc.

Runcell Feb 2023 - Dec 2023
Game Developer, Level Designer Google Drive
- A 3D endless Runner game based on WebGL in My Irancell app
- Designed all stages of the game
- Worked on parts of the code such as parts of Core, Shop, Setting, Missions and Profile

Drift Jan 2024 - May 2024
Game Developer Google Drive
- Developed core gameplay systems for a 2D top-down racing game in Unity using C# for WebGL/H5 platforms
- Implemented custom UI, HUD elements, drifting mechanics, checkpoint logic, and responsive vehicle controls

Tic-Tac-Toe Nov 2020
Game Developer and Designer GitHub Link
- A Tic-Tac-Toe Game included both PVP and PVN options
- Used C++ and Minimax algorithm

Skills

Programming languages: C#, C++, Python, TypeScript

Software: Unity, UE, Git, Cocos Creator, Tiled, Asprite

ML/AI: LLM, RAG, CODEX, Scikit-Learn, Pandas, NLTK, ML-Agent, Gym, Google Colab, Tensorflow, Numpy

Miscellaneous: Figma, Latex, Django, HTML, CSS

Licenses & certifications

Advanced Learning Algorithms (Coursera) Certificate Jun 2023

Supervised Machine Learning: Regression and Classification (Coursera) Certificate Feb 2023

Intro to Game AI and Reinforcement Learning (Kaggle) Certificate Jun 2022

C# (Sololearn) Certificate Mar 2022

C++ (Sololearn) Certificate Mar 2022

Python Core (Sololearn) Certificate Mar 2022

International Computer Drivers License Certificate Oct 2016 - Oct 2021

Languages

English: Duolingo English Test: 115 (Dec 2025 Expired) Link

IELTS (CD Mock Academic on Dec 2025):
Overall: 7.0, Speaking: 6.5, Reading: 6.5,
Listening: 7.5, Writing: 6.5

Persian: Native